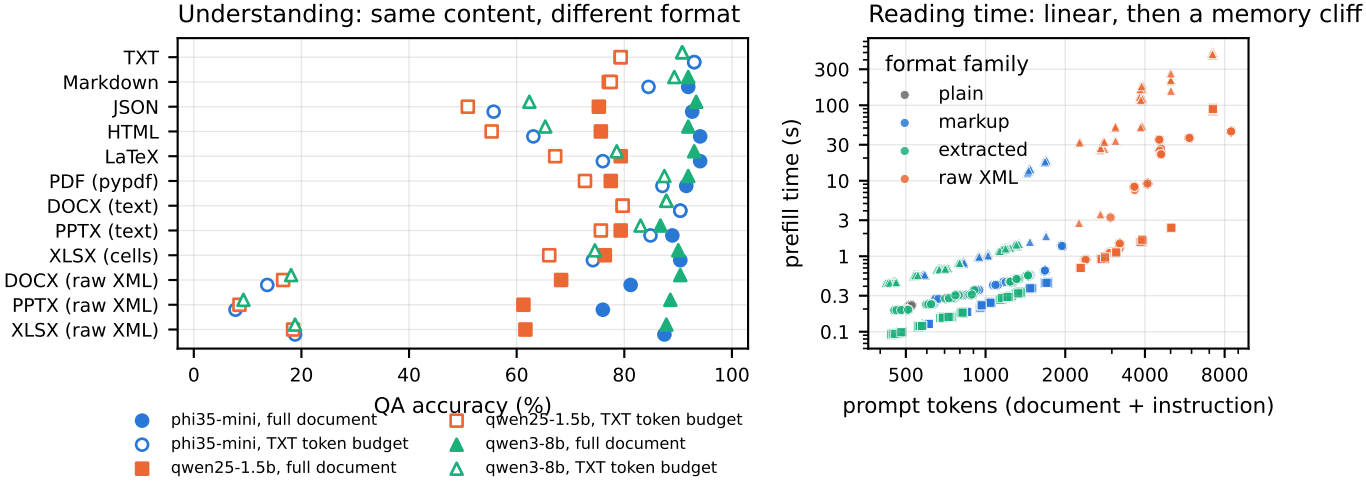
Understanding: same content, different format
TXT
Markdown
JSON
HTML
LaTeX
PDF (pypdf)
DOCX (text)
PPTX (text)
XLSX (cells)
DOCX (raw XML)
PPTX (raw XML)
XLSX (raw XML)
0
20
40
60
80
100
QA accuracy (%)
phi35-mini, full document
phi35-mini, TXT token budget
qwen25-1.5b, full document
qwen25-1.5b, TXT token budget
qwen3-8b, full document
qwen3-8b, TXT token budget
Reading time: linear, then a memory cliff
format family
plain
markup
extracted
raw XML
prefill time (s)
300
100
30
10
3
1
0.3
0.1
500
1000
2000
4000
8000
prompt tokens (document + instruction)